अदृष्टार्थ | adṛṣṭārtha

Etymology

न दृष्टः अदृष्टः । अदृष्टः अर्थः अदृष्टार्थः ।

Derivations

नञ् + दृश—क्त; अर्थ भावकर्म्मादौ यथायथम् अच्

Literal Translation

LANGUAGE	TRANSLATION
English	Matter which is not seen

SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
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Explanation

adṛṣṭārtha refers to verbal testimony (śābda) concerning matters that are not directly perceptible (a-dṛṣṭa-artha). It denotes authoritative statements about objects or phenomena that cannot be directly verified through ordinary perception but must be accepted on the basis of reliable testimony. This includes abstract principles, metaphysical truths, and subtle causal relationships beyond sensory access.

Applicability in Modern Context

In contemporary science, adṛṣṭārtha śābda is fundamental to understanding theoretical entities and imperceptible phenomena. Scientific theories about dark matter, quantum fields, or neurological processes involve claims about entities that cannot be directly perceived but are inferred through instruments, mathematics, and theoretical frameworks.

In religious and ethical discourse, claims about moral principles, spiritual realities, or existential meaning typically fall under adṛṣṭārtha śābda. These dimensions of human experience transcend direct empirical verification yet remain significant domains of knowledge.

The distinction between verifiable and unverifiable claims also informs contemporary discussions about misinformation, conspiracy theories, and the epistemic authority of experts across domains like climate science, medicine, and public policy.

Nyaya Text References

adṛṣṭārthaḥ pravaktā yasyāgamasya sa tathoktaḥ (nyā vā tā ṭī 1/1/8)

dṛṣṭārthasya vākyasyānṛtatvādadṛṣṭārthamapi vākyam``agnihotraṃ juhuyāt svargakāma'' ityādyanṛtamiti jñāyate (nyā bhā 2/1/57)

dṛṣṭārthe saṃśayādapi pravṛttau satyāṃ pravṛttisāmarthyena tasya sujñānatvāt, adṛṣṭārtheṣu pravṛttisāmarthyāvaghṛtamāmāṇyapramāṇasādharmyeṇa tasyaśakyajñānatvāditi darśitaṃ prathame sūtre (nyā vā tā ṭī 2/1/16)

kimarthaṃ punaridamucyate? sa na manyeta dṛṣṭārtha evāptopadeśaḥ pramāṇam, arthasyāvadhāraṇāditi, adṛṣṭārtho 'pi pramāṇamarthasyānumānāditi (nyā bhā 1/1/8)

adṛṣṭārthaviṣayasya ca caturvargasyehārthavattvena prayojanaṃ dṛṣṭārthe sandehādapi vyavahāra siddheḥ (nyā vā tā ṭī 1/1/1)